We use chemical changes in various forms in our daily life. **Chemistry** is the branch of science which deals with the study of particles around us. The beauty of chemistry is that, it explains the properties of the basic components of particles such as atoms and molecules and the effects of their combination.

We can consider all the particles around us as chemicals. The water (H_2O) we drink is the combination of hydrogen and oxygen. The salt (NaCl) we use in our kitchen is a combination of the chemicals, sodium and chlorine. Even our body is made up of a lot of chemical particles.

We could prepare soft idly as a result of a chemical change named fermentation takes place in the idly batter. During fermentation the idly batter undergoes a chemical change by bacteria. While cooking, the food products undergo so many chemical changes. As a result there are favourable changes in colour, flavour and taste in the food.

We can use chemical changes to produce certain materials. For example, some of the objects such as soaps, fertilizers, plastics and cement which we use in our daily life can be prepared by making chemical changes in some naturally occurring objects.

Activity 1: Discuss with your group and list out few chemicals which we use in our home and school.

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We can study about the manufacturing processes and usages of certain materials we use in our daily life such as **soaps, fertilizers, cement, gypsum, Epsom, plaster of paris, phenol** and adhesives in this lesson.

3.1 Soaps and Detergents

Bathing soap and washing detergents are kinds of soaps which we use in our daily life. In addition to this, we are

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DO YOU KNOW?

When we cut onion, we get tears in the eyes with irritation, because of the presence of a chemical, propanethial s-oxide in onion. This is easily volatile. When we cut onion some of the cells are damaged and this chemical comes out. It becomes vapour and reach our eyes result in irritation and tears in eyes. When we crush the onion, more cells will be damaged and more chemicals come out.



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